Sebastian Garcia-Torres

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Born in Quito, Ecuador
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Working Experience

Pre-Doctoral Research Fellow — September 2025 – Present
Harvard Kennedy School (Center for International Development)

Research Assistant — May 2021 – August 2025
Economics Department J.-F.-Kennedy Institute Freie Universität Berlin

Internship — September – October 2023
ifo Center for International Institutional Comparisons and Migration Research

Internship — May – August 2022
Federal Ministry of Finance Germany

Project Developer — April – December 2021
Innocence in Danger e.V.

Internship — September 2020 – March 2021
Innocence in Danger e.V.

Education

M.Sc. Public Economics [1,0 equivalent to 4.0 GPA] — 2023 – 2025
Freie Universität Berlin

B.Sc. Economics [1,2 equivalent to 3.8 GPA] — 2019 – 2023
Freie Universität Berlin

German High-School Diploma — 2016 – 2019
German School in Quito Ecuador

Ecuadorian High-School Diploma — 2005 – 2019
German School in Quito Ecuador

Research

Women in Political Power and School Closure during COVID Times (with N. Danzer, M. Steinhardt & L. Stella). 2024. **Economic Policy**, 39(120), 765-810. [read]

Teaching Experience

TA: Lecture series "Financial Crises and Monetary Systems"
Freie Universität Berlin — Summer terms 2020 & 2021

TA: Lecture series "Paradigms and Controversies of Economic Theories"
Freie Universität Berlin — Winter terms 20/21 & 21/22

Academic Engagement

Student representative, Institute Council for Economics — January 2024 – September 2025
School of Business and Economics Freie Universität Berlin

Member, Appointments Committee, Microeconomics Professorship — July 2022 – February 2023
School of Business and Economics Freie Universität Berlin

Student Deputy Representative, Faculty Council (FBR) October 2021 – December 2022
School of Business and Economics Freie Universität Berlin

Student Chairperson, Educational Commission (ABK) September 2021 – September 2022
School of Business and Economics Freie Universität Berlin

Conferences and Workshops

2025: 14th Alpine Population Conference (Bocconni), Harvard CID Research Xchange
2024: Conference of the European Society for Population Economics (ESPE), BeNA Winter Workshop
2023: The Economics of Gender (Paris School of Economics), ifo CEMIR Seminar

Awards and Scolarships

Deutschlandstipendium scholarship 2023 – 2025
Freie Universität Berlin, Germany

DAAD Prize for outstanding achievements of international students 2023
Freie Universität Berlin, Germany

European Union standard-bearer for academic performance 2019
German School in Quito, Ecuador

Skills

Languages: Spanish (mother tounge), German (C2), English (C1)
StatisticalProgramming Languages: Stata, Python, R
Other IT-Skills: LaTeX, QGIS, Microsoft Office, EViews

Research Interests

Political Economics; Development Economics; Gender Economics; Economic History

References

Eliana La Ferrara
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Max Steinhardt
Chair of the Department of Economics J.-F.-Kennedy Institute, Freie Universität Berlin
Mail: max.steinhardt@fu-berlin.de

Natalia Danzer
Chair of Empirical Economics and Gender, Freie Universität Berlin
Mail: natalia.danzer@fu-berlin.de